

FUTURE SKILLS SERIES

AI Literacy • Media Literacy

WORKS ON ANY STORY, ANY WEEK

News Desk Frames

Any story. Ten ways
to think it through.

Grades 6–8

10 one-page frames

No prep • No devices needed



THE NEWS DESK PACK • ANY STORY

News Desk Day



A 45-minute routine that turns any news story into a thinking lesson. Pick a story, pick a frame, run the method. Ten frames, one skeleton, no prep, fully on paper. Bell-ringer version on page 2.

AT A GLANCE

TIME	MATERIALS	TECH NEEDED	PREP
45 min (25 as a bell-ringer)	One frame per student (Frames PDF; typeable copy included) · the story, printed, projected or read aloud · Slides (optional) · Teacher Guide (safe-story rules p. 1, script per frame, rubric p. 4) · board for the tally · pens	None — runs fully unplugged. Devices only add: Frames 1 and 8 can open a second source live	Pick a story (Teacher Guide p. 1 rules) and a frame (table below). Print. That's it.

OBJECTIVES

ISTE 1.3.b

CCSS ELA RI.6.8

CCSS ELA W.6.1

CSTA 2-IC-20

CCSS Math 7.RP.A.3

On any story they are handed, students can...

- Trace a story's claims and judge which are backed by a second source. (*Frames 1, 8; rubric row "evidence"*)
- Compare who gains and who loses from a change in technology, make a call, defend it. (*Frames 2, 3, 9; rubric "claim"*)
- Turn a price change into a percent and a cost per unit, then into a rule. (*Frames 5, 6; rubric "method followed"*)
- Say plainly why the story matters to someone their age. (*every frame's "So what?"; rubric "said plainly"*)

PICK THE FRAME — STORY TYPE → FRAME

	THE STORY IS ABOUT...	FRAME	THE QUESTION IT ANSWERS
1	A claim that sounds too neat for a post going viral	Fact Desk	Is it true?
2	A new tool, app or feature that changes how people do something	The Trade	Who wins, who loses?
3	A school, city or company setting a new rule	Write the Rule	What should the rule be?
4	A free app or site that changes owners or adds ads	Who Pays for Free?	If it's free, who pays?
5	A subscription, plan or bundle sold in tiers	Unit Rate Receipt	Which deal is really cheaper?
6	A price going up or down	Percent Change Card	How big is the change, really?
7	An artist, game or brand saying something copied them	Copy, Style, or Person?	What got copied?
8	A study, report or survey with a big number in it	Source Check	Who's telling me this, and why?
9	An AI helper that can act on someone's photos, messages or accounts	Permission Slip	What may it do on its own?
10	A theft, hack, outage or loss	Risk Grid	What would hurt most to lose?

OPEN — HEADLINE ONLY (5 MIN)

Show or read the headline and nothing else. Ask: "What question does this headline make you want to ask?"

Take three answers, then name the frame: "That's a Frame 2 question — who wins, who loses. That's today's frame."

If nobody has a question: read the first sentence aloud and ask which word they would check. That is a Frame 1 question. If every question is about a person: "We frame the change, not the person. What changed?"

Hand-out (say it): "Frames out. Top box first: the story, where you saw it, the date. Then we read."

Q ONE RUBRIC — SCORES ANY FRAME

	STRONG (3)	GETTING THERE (2)	NOT YET (1)
Claim	One clear verdict, call or pick, checked once, that answers the frame's question.	A call is made but hedged, or two boxes are checked.	No call, or the call doesn't answer the frame's question.
Evidence	Names something specific: a claim from the story, a second source, a number worked out on the page.	Points at the story in general ("it says so").	Opinion only. No source, no number.
Method followed	Every numbered step done in order, and it shows: rankings, grid cells, math.	A step skipped or out of order; the result still holds.	Jumped to the boxes; steps blank.
Said plainly	The "So what?" says why it matters to someone their age, in words they'd say out loud.	Matters to "people" or "society".	Blank, or repeats the headline.

12 possible. 10–12 strong · 7–9 getting there, one fix · below 7, redo one step with you. Score the evidence, not the answer: two students can disagree and both score 12.

WHEN IT GOES SIDEWAYS

The story a student brings is about a person. → "We frame the change, not the person. What changed?" If nothing changed, it's gossip, not news. Pick another.

"It's true, it was on the news." Or the second source is "the same AI" or "the same account". → "Which outlet? Now name one more that didn't copy it. Same voice doesn't count." That's Frame 1, step 3, and the gloss under its table.

The room splits into two loud sides. → "Score the evidence, not the side. Who named a source, followed a step and said it plainly?" Then move to share-out.

The math frames stall (5, 6). → Do row one on the board together, then hand it back. The stall is nearly always the unit, or dividing by the new price instead of the old.

The story turns out to be political after all. → Stop, name rule 4 from page 1, swap the story. Frames survive a swap. You lose five minutes, not the period.

FULL STANDARDS TEXT

- **ISTE 1.3.b** — Students evaluate the accuracy, perspective, credibility and relevance of information, media, data or other resources. *Taught: Frame 1 step 3 (name a second source) and Frame 8 steps 1–3 (who made it, who paid, what they gain). Assessed: Frame 1's "Second source" column, Frame 8's "Would I trust it?" line; rubric row "Evidence".*
- **CCSS ELA RI.6.8** — Trace and evaluate the argument and specific claims in a text, distinguishing claims that are supported by reasons and evidence from claims that are not. *Taught: Frame 1 steps 1–2 (underline and rank claims) and Frame 8 step 4 (fact the source shows vs. opinion it implies). Assessed: Frame 1's verdict plus "My evidence" line; Frame 8's five-statement table.*
- **CCSS ELA W.6.1** — Write arguments to support claims with clear reasons and relevant evidence. *Taught: Frame 3 step 5 (defend one rule: the rule, the reason, the proof) and Frame 2 step 5 (my call, because). Assessed: Frame 3's three-sentence defense; rubric rows "Claim" and "Evidence".*
- **CSTA 2-IC-20** — Compare tradeoffs associated with computing technologies that affect people's everyday activities and career options. *Taught: Frame 2 (who wins, who loses, what could go wrong) and Frame 9 (allow, check first, deny). Assessed: Frame 2's "My call" box and "because" line; Frame 9's eight reasons and the risky combo.*
- **CCSS Math 7.RP.A.3** — Use proportional relationships to solve multistep ratio and percent problems. Examples: simple interest, tax, markups and markdowns, gratuities and commissions, fees, percent increase and decrease, percent error. *Taught: Frame 6 steps 2–5 (difference, percent change, hours of work, an eight-week plan). Assessed: Frame 6's percent cell, "Show it" line and save-up table; rubric row "Method followed".*